

Back In Majors After 30-Year Wait

New Phillies Coach Is Jewish Jackie Robinson

By ED NICHOLS

Sports Editor, The Times

This is a story about Andy Cohen — the Jewish Jackie Robinson.

The new coach of the Phillies, easy to interview, via telephone, starts off by saying, "I'm 54 years old, and have been in this baseball business 35 years.

"Yes, I guess you could call me the Jewish Jackie Robinson at that," he declared with a chuckle. "There had been Jewish players before me in the majors, but none of them stayed long.

"John McGraw (manager of New York Giants) thought my name would create additional rooting interest among the Hebrew population of New York.

"And think of my position. I had to beat out two second basemen like Frankie Frisch and Rogers Hornsby.

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"ACTUALLY I had my first shot in 1926 when Frisch was there. They sent me back, and in '27 the Giants got Hornsby for Frisch. Next year they traded Hornsby, and I became the regular second baseman.

"Me being a Jewish boy was something of a novelty in the big leagues. The fans gawked at me as if I didn't belong, but my strangeness didn't last long.

"The rival players gave me a heckling quite often the first year, just as McGraw said they would. 'Don't say nothing back to them,' he advised. 'That's just what they want you to do.'

"The New York papers front-paged me every day for a while — if I made a base hit or error, it made no difference."

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COHEN ADMIRE McGraw for his discipline. He had two seasons to admire him, however.

"I hit .274 and .294 — a guy never forgets his major league



ANDY COHEN

batting averages," he said, "but McGraw got down on me one day. He said I had 'football legs.' I did play three years of varsity football at University of Alabama.

"I hit a hump-back liner over second base one day. It was in Cincinnati. I thought it was a hit. I had hurt my leg and didn't want to tell Mac because I wanted to stay in the lineup. Hughie Critz ran back, came up with the ball, and threw me out. Mac blew his stack when I came back to the dugout. That was the end of my major league career.

"Funny thing about it is Critz became the next Giants' second baseman."

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COHEN WAS then traded to the Newark International League club for lefthander Hub Pruett, who had the distinction of whiffing Babe Ruth 13 straight times with the St. Louis Browns.

He hit .300 or better in seven of the nine years in triple-A ball, but never got another shot at the majors.

"Now, I'm back in the majors after a wait of 30 years," Cohen said.

"I've managed in every minor league classification — Class D to triple A.

"But it's great to be back in the majors. Thirty years is a long time.

"Yes, I guess you could call me the Jewish Jackie Robinson. I never thought of it that way though."

Fight Results

By THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

Los Angeles —Paulie Armstead, 135½, Los Angeles, outpointed Hilario Morales, 136, Mexico, 10.

Boise, Idaho — Jimmy Grow, 138, Lewiston, Idaho, and The Javellana Kid, 138, Philippines, drew, 10.

New York (Sunnyside Garden) — Bobby Bartels, 146, New York, stopped Irish Pat Mullane, 143, Waterbury, Conn., 2.

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